

Meoncross School History Department

YEAR 10 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-2027)

Curriculum Planning & Lesson Companion

Key Stage 4 Curriculum Architecture & Edexcel GCSE Specification

Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1) History Specification (1H10)

Meoncross School delivers a balanced 4-unit curriculum covering thematic development, British depth, period conflict, and modern world history:

Exam Paper & Topic	Assessment Focus	Weighting	Format & Marks	Taught Cohort
Paper 1 (1H10/11): Medicine in Britain (c.1250–present) & Western Front (1914–18)	Thematic Study & Historic Environment	30% of GCSE	1 hr 15 mins 52 marks (incl. 4 SPaG)	Year 11
Paper 2 (1H10/26): Conflict in the Middle East (1945–1995)	Period Study	20% of GCSE	50 mins 32 marks	Year 10
Paper 2 (1H10/26): Early Elizabethan England (1558–1588)	British Depth Study	20% of GCSE	55 mins 32 marks	Year 11
Paper 3 (1H10/31): Weimar and Nazi Germany (1918–1939)	Modern Depth Study	30% of GCSE	1 hr 20 mins 52 marks (incl. 4 SPaG)	Year 10

Assessment Objectives (AOs)

- **AO1 (35%):** Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of key features.
- **AO2 (35%):** Explain and analyse events, causes, consequences, and change.
- **AO3 (15%):** Analyse, evaluate, and use contemporary sources.
- **AO4 (15%):** Analyse and evaluate historical interpretations in context.

Standardized Question Frameworks

- **4-mark Consequence:** PEE structure (immediate & long-term).
- **8-mark Narrative:** 3-phase chronological causal flowchart.
- **8-mark Importance:** Analytical criteria for historical impact.
- **2+2 Features:** Concisely identifying and developing features.
- **8-mark Utility:** Evaluating content and provenance (Author/Audience/Motive).
- **16+4 Judgement Essays:** Evaluative criteria with sustained balance.

Mastery Methodology: GCSE pupils utilize printed Edexcel Mastery Booklets featuring 3-tier models, formula stamps, and walking-talking mock rehearsals, ensuring complete familiarity with mark schemes and timing constraints prior to the final examinations.

Paper 2: Conflict in the Middle East, 1945–1995

Year 10 | Why has peace proved so elusive in the Middle East?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 KT 1.0: Broken Promises & Imperial Borders: Why Was Conflict in the Middle East Inevitable?	• Understand how the collapse of the Ottoman Empire after WW1 and the secret Sykes-Picot Agreement (1916) created artificial borders and European mandates in the Middle East. • Examine conflicting British wartime promises: the McMahon-Hussein Correspondence (1915) versus the Balfour Declaration (1917). • Define and contrast the core historical ideologies of Zionism and Arab Nationalism. • Identify the strategic geography of the region, including vital maritime chokepoints (Suez Canal, Straits of Tiran) and contested territories (West Bank, Gaza Strip, Golan Heights, Sinai Peninsula).	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 2 KT 1.1: The End of the British Mandate and the Creation of Israel, 1945–1949	- Understand the conflicting interests and demands of Jews and Arabs within the British Mandate. - Analyze the key events leading to the end of the British Mandate, partition and the creation of Israel, including the significance of the bombing of the King David Hotel and UN Resolution 181. - Describe the key events of the Arab-Israeli war (1948–49).	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 3 KT 1.2: The Aftermath of the 1948–49 War & The Palestinian Refugee Crisis	- Explain the territorial changes and their impact, including the refugee status of Palestinian Arabs. - Understand the creation of the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) and the Law of Return (1950), and the importance of US aid to Israel. - Analyze Israel's relations with Egypt in the aftermath of the war.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 4 KT 1.3: Increased Tension, Nasser, and the Suez Crisis, 1955–1963	- Understand Nasser and Egypt's leadership of the Arab world. - Analyze the events and significance of Israeli attacks on Gaza in 1955 and Sinai in 1956. - Evaluate the events and significance of the Suez Crisis (1956), including the formation of the United Arab Republic (UAR) in 1958.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 5 KT 2.1: The Six Day War, June 1967	- Understand the significance of the Cairo Conference (1964) and the growth of Fatah and the PLO. - Analyze the escalating tension between Israel, Syria and Jordan: Syria's support for Fatah, Israel's raid on Samu and the events of 7 April 1967. - Evaluate the actions of the USSR, Nasser and the USA in the period leading to war, and the key events of the war.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 6 KT 2.2: The Aftermath of the 1967 War & The Rise of Palestinian Resistance	- Understand UN Resolution 242 and the continued dispute over the Suez Canal. - Analyze the situation of Palestinian refugees and the significance of the occupied territories: Golan Heights, Gaza Strip, West Bank, Sinai and East Jerusalem. - Evaluate the use of terrorism, Israel's response and international attitudes towards the Palestine issue: the PFLP airplane hijacks of 1970; Black September and the Munich Olympics; and the expulsion of the PLO from Jordan (1970).	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 7 KT 2.3: Israel and Egypt: The War of Attrition and the Yom Kippur War, 1967–1973	- Analyze Egyptian relations with Israel, the USA, the USSR and other Arab states. - Understand Israel's consolidation of control of the occupied territories. - Describe the key events of the Yom Kippur War (1973) and its aftermath.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 8 KT 3.1: Diplomatic Negotiations: From Shuttle Diplomacy to Camp David, 1974–1979	- Understand the significance of the oil crisis and the involvement of the USA and the USSR. - Analyze Kissinger, 'shuttle diplomacy' and the reopening of the Suez Canal. - Evaluate Sadat's visit to Israel (1977), Begin's visit to Egypt (1977), US President Carter and Camp David (1978) and the Treaty of Washington (1979).	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 9 KT 3.2: The Palestinian Issue: Lebanon, Sabra & Shatila, and the First Intifada, 1974–1993	- Understand Arafat's speech to the UN (1974) and the significance of PLO activities in Lebanon. - Analyze Israeli reprisals, the invasion of Lebanon (1982) and the results. - Evaluate the situation in the Israeli occupied territories and the First Palestinian Intifada (1987–93).	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 10 KT 3.3: Attempts at a Solution: From the Oslo Accords to Oslo II, 1988–1995	- Understand the significance of Arafat's renunciation of terrorism in a speech at the UN (1988). - Analyze changing superpower policies in the Middle East: US involvement in the Gulf War (1991), and the end of the Cold War. - Evaluate Arafat, Rabin and the Oslo Accords (1993); the setting up of the Palestinian National Authority; the Israel-Jordan peace treaty (1994); and Oslo II (1995).	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Unit Key Vocabulary: Zionism • Anti-Semitism • Mandate • Balfour Declaration • Haganah • Irgun (IZL) • Lehi (The Stern Gang) • Nakba • Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) • Law of Return • Fedayeen • United Arab Republic (UAR) • Fatah • Palestine Liberation Organisation (PLO) • Popular Front for the Liberation of Palestine (PFLP) • UN Resolution 242 • Black September Organization (BSO) • OPEC • Shuttle Diplomacy • Camp David Accords • Treaty of Washington • Intifada • Hamas • Hezbollah • Palestinian National Authority (PNA) • Unified National Leadership of the Uprising (UNLU) • Area C		

Paper 3: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918–39

Year 10 | From Democracy to Dictatorship: How did Hitler destroy the Weimar Republic?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 KT1.1: The Origins of the Republic, 1918–1919	- Demonstrate precise knowledge of the catastrophic social, economic, and political conditions in Germany at the end of WWI that triggered the Kaiser's abdication. - Analyse the sequence of events from the Kiel mutiny to the declaration of the Republic, explaining why Friedrich Ebert and the SPD acted to prevent a communist revolution. - Evaluate the democratic strengths and structural weaknesses of the Weimar Constitution, particularly the 'fatal flaws' of Proportional Representation and Article 48.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 2 KT1.2: Early Challenges to the Republic, 1919–1923	- Demonstrate precise knowledge of the terms of the Treaty of Versailles and explain why many Germans saw it as a 'diktat' and a national humiliation. - Analyse the differing threats posed by left-wing uprisings (the Spartacist revolt, 1919) and right-wing challenges (the Kapp Putsch, 1920), evaluating why the government survived both. - Evaluate the causes and devastating impact of the 1923 hyperinflation crisis, using specific evidence to show how it destroyed the savings and trust of the German middle class.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 3 KT1.3: The Recovery of the Republic, 1924–1929	• Demonstrate precise knowledge of Stresemann's economic reforms: the Rentenmark, the Dawes Plan (1924), and the Young Plan (1929). • Analyse how Stresemann's foreign policy achievements—particularly the Locarno Pact (1925) and Germany's entry into the League of Nations (1926)—restored Germany's international status. • Evaluate the extent to which the 'Golden Age' was a genuine recovery or a fragile illusion built on American loans that could collapse at any moment.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 4 KT1.4: Changes in Society, 1924–1929	• Demonstrate precise knowledge of how living standards improved for workers through wages, housing, and welfare reforms funded by American loans. • Analyse the dramatic changes in women's rights, roles, and cultural freedoms under the Weimar Constitution, particularly Article 109. • Evaluate how the cultural explosion in Berlin (Expressionism, Bauhaus, cinema) both represented the Republic's greatest achievements and simultaneously deepened political divisions.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 5 KT2.1: The Early Development of the Nazi Party, 1919–1922	• Demonstrate precise knowledge of the origins of the DAP, Hitler's early role, and his transformation of the party into the NSDAP. • Analyse the key ideas of the 25-Point Programme, distinguishing between its nationalist, anti-Semitic, and socialist elements. • Evaluate the importance of Hitler's oratory skills, the creation of the SA, and the adoption of the swastika in establishing the NSDAP as a significant far-right movement by 1922.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 6 KT2.2: The Munich Putsch and the Lean Years, 1923–1929	• Demonstrate precise knowledge of the causes and events of the Munich Beer Hall Putsch of November 1923. • Analyse how Hitler turned his trial and imprisonment into a political opportunity, writing 'Mein Kampf' and adopting the 'legal route' strategy to gain power through elections. • Evaluate why the Nazi Party remained electorally insignificant during the 'Lean Years' (winning only 12 seats in 1928) despite considerable organisational growth under the Bamberg Conference structure.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 7 KT2.3: The Growth of Nazi Support, 1929–1932	• Demonstrate precise knowledge of how the Wall Street Crash triggered mass unemployment in Germany and destroyed Weimar's fragile economic recovery. • Analyse the reasons why different social groups (farmers, the Mittelstand, industrialists, and the unemployed) turned to the Nazi Party, and how Goebbels' propaganda targeted each group. • Evaluate the role of the SA's street violence and Hitler's 'negative cohesion' strategy in making the Nazis appear as the only party strong enough to defeat both communism and democratic weakness.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 8 KT2.4: How Hitler Became Chancellor, 1932–1933	• Demonstrate precise knowledge of the key political players (Brüning, von Papen, von Schleicher, and Hindenburg) and the sequence of failed chancellorships from 1930 to 1933. • Analyse how the use of Article 48 and 'presidential decrees' gradually destroyed Weimar democracy and created the conditions for Hitler's appointment. • Evaluate the fatal miscalculation of the conservative elites—particularly von Papen's belief that Hitler could be controlled as a 'puppet chancellor'—and explain why this backfired.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 9 Key Topic 3.1: The Creation of a Dictatorship, 1933–1934	• Demonstrate precise knowledge of how the Reichstag Fire (February 1933) was exploited to pass the emergency decree suspending civil liberties. • Analyse how the Enabling Act (March 1933) and the process of Gleichschaltung systematically destroyed all opposition parties, trade unions, and state governments. • Evaluate the significance of the Night of the Long Knives (June 1934) and Hindenburg's death (August 1934) in allowing Hitler to combine the roles of Chancellor, President, and Commander-in-Chief as 'Führer'.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 10 Key Topic 3.2: The Police State and Religion, 1933–1939	• Demonstrate precise knowledge of the different, overlapping branches of the Nazi police state, distinguishing between the roles of the SS, SD, and Gestapo. • Analyse how the Nazis completely removed the independence of the German legal system to ensure the courts always ruled in Hitler's favour. • Evaluate the varying successes and failures of Nazi policies towards the Catholic and Protestant churches.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 11 Key Topic 3.3: Controlling and Influencing Attitudes, 1933–1939	• Demonstrate precise knowledge of the methods Goebbels used to censor the press, literature, and radio. • Analyse how the Nazis utilised mass rallies, the 1936 Berlin Olympics, and cheap technology (like the Volksempfänger) as tools of indoctrination. • Evaluate the ways in which the Nazis crushed independent thought by controlling art, architecture, and music through the Reich Chamber of Culture.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 12 Key Topic 3.4: Opposition, Resistance and Conformity, 1933–1939	• Demonstrate precise knowledge of the different youth opposition groups, distinguishing between the working-class Edelweiss Pirates and the middle-class Swing Youth. • Analyse the methods used by underground political networks, industrial workers, and lone-wolf attackers to resist the Nazi state. • Evaluate the reasons why the vast majority of the German population conformed to Nazi rule rather than actively opposing it.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 13 Key Topic 4.1: Nazi Policies Towards Women, 1933–1939	• Demonstrate precise knowledge of the laws and incentives used to increase the birth rate and promote traditional marriage. • Analyse the methods used by the NS-Frauenschaft and the Deutsches Frauenwerk to control women's daily lives and education. • Evaluate the 'great contradiction' of Nazi policy: why female employment actually increased between 1933 and 1939 despite ideological attempts to force women out of the workplace.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 14 Key Topic 4.2: Nazi Policies Towards the Young, 1933–1939	• Demonstrate precise knowledge of how the school curriculum and teaching profession were completely 'Nazified' by Bernhard Rust. • Analyse the differences between the youth movements for boys (military preparation) and girls (domestic preparation). • Evaluate the extent to which Nazi youth policies were a success, acknowledging the Grade 9 nuance that resistance did exist.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 15 Key Topic 4.3: Employment and Living Standards, 1933–1939	• Demonstrate precise knowledge of the government schemes used to reduce unemployment (RAD, public works, and rearmament). • Analyse the shift in economic leadership from Schacht's 'New Plan' to Goering's 'Four Year Plan' and the goal of Autarky. • Evaluate the extent to which the Nazi economic recovery was a statistical illusion (invisible unemployment) and assess the true impact on living standards.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 16 Key Topic 4.4: The Persecution of Minorities, 1933–1939	• Demonstrate precise knowledge of Nazi racial ideology, distinguishing between 'Untermenschen' and 'Asocials'. • Analyse the escalating stages of anti-Semitic persecution: from early boycotts (1933) to legislation (1935), bureaucratic dehumanisation (1938), and state-sponsored violence. • Evaluate the brutal methods used against the disabled, Roma/Sinti, and homosexuals, including the Marzahn camp, sterilisation, and the T4 programme.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

Unit Key Vocabulary: Reichstag • Reichsrat • Armistice • Constitution • Dolchstoßlegende • November Criminals • Proportional Representation (PR) • Coalition Government • Article 48 • Diktat • Reparations • Spartacist League • Freikorps • Putsch • Passive Resistance • Hyperinflation • Rentenmark • Reichsmark • Dawes Plan (1924) • Young Plan (1929) • Locarno Pact (1925) • League of Nations • Kellogg-Briand Pact (1928) • Standard of Living • Unemployment Insurance Act (1927) • New Woman (Neue Frau) • Article 109 • Avant-garde • New Objectivity (Neue Sachlichkeit) • Bauhaus • DAP (German Workers' Party) • NSDAP (National Socialist German Workers' Party) • 25-Point Programme • Nationalism • Socialism • SA (Sturmabteilung) • Stosstrupp (Shock Troop) • Völkischer Beobachter • The Bavarian Triumvirate • Treason • Landsberg Prison • Mein Kampf ('My Struggle') • Führerprinzip (The Leadership Principle) • Gauleiter • SS (Schutzstaffel) • Aryan • The Wall Street Crash • KPD (Communist Party of Germany) • Hermann Müller • Heinrich Brüning • Negative Cohesion • Rotfrontkämpferbund (Red Front Fighters' League) • Paul von Hindenburg • The Camarilla • Franz von Papen • Kurt von Schleicher • Backstairs Intrigue • Cabinet • SD (Sicherheitsdienst) • Gestapo • Schutzhaft (Protective Custody) • The Concordat (1933) • Reich Church • Confessional Church • Censorship • Propaganda • Ministry of Public Enlightenment and Propaganda • Volksempfänger (People's Receiver) • Reich Chamber of Culture • Entartete Kunst (Degenerate Art) • Conformity • Active Resistance • Sopade Reports • Sabotage • Edelweiss Pirates • Swing Youth • Kinder, Küche, Kirche • Law for the Encouragement of Marriage (1933) • The Mother's Cross (Mutterkreuz) • Lebensborn (Spring of Life) • NS-Frauenschaft (NSF) • Deutsches Frauenwerk (DFW) • Gertrud Scholtz-Klink • Indoctrination • National Socialist Teachers' League (NSLB) • Bernhard Rust • Eugenics (Race Studies) • Hitlerjugend (HJ) • Bund Deutscher Mädel (BDM) • Faith and Beauty Society • Invisible Unemployment • Autarky • Ersatz • Hermann Goering • National Labour Service (RAD) • German Labour Front (DAF) • Strength Through Joy (KdF) • Beauty of Labour (SdA) • Volksgemeinschaft • Social Darwinism • Untermenschen • Asocials • Anti-Semitism • Eugenics • Aryanisation